

FIRST SEMESTER CONCISE REVIEW

PART 1 : VOCABULARY

THEME 1 : FINANCE AND BUSINESS VOCABULARY

LEXICAL ITEMS	EXPLANATION (S)	EXAMPLES
Bankrupt (adj) go into bankruptcy	Be unable to pay the debts	<i>The company went into bankruptcy after its investment in unsustainable energy technology failed to generate profits.</i>
debt	Money owed by one party (borrower) to another (lender)	A student loan of \$20,000 is a debt that the borrower must repay over time with interest.
Dividends	Payments made by a corporation to its shareholders from profits	<i>The company pays Dividends to shareholders when it makes a profit</i>
exorbitant	Extremely high or unreasonably large in price or cost	The concert tickets had an exorbitant service fee that doubled the final price.
extravagant	Spending much more than necessary; lavish or excessive in consumption or lifestyle	Hosting an extravagant wedding with designer decor and a gourmet menu can cost far more than a modest celebration.
frugal	Careful about spending money; economical and avoiding waste while still meeting needs	Being frugal , she bought a high-quality jacket on sale and repaired it when needed instead of replacing it each season.
invoice	A detailed bill sent by a seller to a buyer listing goods or services provided	The contractor sent an invoice for \$2,500 detailing labor and materials, with payment due in 30 days
mortgage	A long-term loan used to purchase a house for example	They took out a 30-year mortgage to buy their house and make monthly payments to the lender.
overdraft	A bank account condition where withdrawals exceed the available balance	Paying a large bill without realizing the account balance was low led to an overdraft and a fee from the bank.
wage	Payment to a worker for labor, typically expressed as an hourly, daily, or weekly rate	The job advertisement listed a wage of \$15 per hour for weekend shifts.
welfare	Government programs or financial assistance that provide support to individuals or families in need	After losing her job, she applied for welfare benefits to help cover food and rent while searching for new work.
Rebate	A partial refund given to a buyer after a purchase, usually as an incentive or promotion	The appliance advertised a \$50 mail-in rebate — customers pay full price up front and submit a form to receive the rebate later.

THEME 2 : LEARNING AND EDUCATION VOCABULARY

LEXICAL ITEMS	EXPLANATION (S)	EXAMPLES
day release	<i>a program arrangement allowing an employee or a student to attend scheduled training or classes during paid work hours</i>	<i>The university offers a day release program that allows employees to attend classes during work hours.</i>
enroll	<i>formally register or sign up for a course, program, or institution so that you become an official participant or student.</i>	<i>Students must enroll in their chosen courses before the deadline to secure their place.</i>
grant	<i>a sum of money given by a government, foundation, or institution to support research mission, or a project; does not usually need to be repaid.</i>	<i>The research foundation provided a grant to fund the study on artificial intelligence in ecological monitoring.</i>
literacy	<i>the ability to read and write; can also refer to competence in a specific domain (e.g., digital literacy, financial literacy).</i>	<i>Digital literacy programs have become essential as more educational resources move online.</i>
prospectus	<i>a document that outlines the aims, structure, content, and requirements of a proposed course, degree program, research project, or publication, training periods; used to inform and attract participants or funders.</i>	<i>The university's prospectus contains detailed information about all courses ,admission requirements, the period of training, sociocultural activities and other specific details</i>
seminar	<i>a small-group academic meeting where participants discuss specialized topics, often led by a professor or student presenters; emphasizes discussion and critical engagement rather than lecture.</i>	<i>The seminar for the environmental science course includes a module on IoT applications in conservation.</i>
syllabus	<i>an outline of a course that lists learning objectives, topics, required readings, assessment methods, deadlines, and policies; serves as a contract between instructor and students.</i>	<i>The syllabus for the environmental science course includes a module on IoT applications in conservation.</i>
tutorial	<i>an instructional session with individualized or small-group attention focused on clarifying material, practicing skills, or providing feedback; can be led by a tutor or instructor.</i>	<i>After lecture, students attend a tutorial to work through problem sets with a teaching assistant.</i>
Scholastic Aptitude Test	<i>a standardized test historically used in some countries to assess college readiness and aptitude for academic study</i>	<i>Applicants submitted their Scholastic Aptitude Test scores as part of the admissions packet to demonstrate readiness for undergraduate study.</i>

THEME 3 : MAINSTREAM MEDIA

LEXICAL ITEMS	EXPLANATION (S)	EXAMPLES
broadsheet	A large-format newspaper traditionally associated with more serious journalism, in-depth reporting, and formal writing style.	<i>Unlike tabloids, broadsheet newspapers typically provide more in-depth analysis of environmental policies.</i>
censorship	The suppression, restriction, or control of information, ideas, or artistic expression by authorities or institutions	<i>Many countries are implementing censorship regulations to control misinformation about climate change on social media</i>
check book journalism	A practice where reporters or news outlets pay sources for interviews, documents, or tips, which can create conflicts of interest and ethical concerns	A tabloid offers a celebrity money for an exclusive interview—this is often criticized as checkbook journalism.
dumbing down	Simplifying content so that complexity, or critical detail is lost, often to increase mass appeal.	<i>Critics argue that the simplification of complex scientific topics in the media represents an intensive dumbing down of important information</i>
gutter press	Derogatory term for low-quality tabloid media that emphasizes scandal, sensationalism, and invasion of privacy over factual reporting	he celebrity's private photos were published by the gutter press without consent.
libel	A false written statement presented as fact that harms a person's reputation; a civil offense that can lead to legal action	<i>The reporter was accused of libel after publishing a false written report about a celebrity</i>
libelous	Descriptive adjective for a statement or publication that constitutes libel (i.e., false and damaging statement when published in writing)	The reporter's claim that the mayor accepted bribes was libelous because it was unverified and false.
media tycoon	An individual who owns or controls a large number of media businesses (newspapers, TV stations, online platforms) and holds significant influence over public discourse	A billionaire who owns multiple national newspapers and television networks is often called a media tycoon .
Slander (verb or noun)/ slandorous (adjective)	A false spoken statement that damages a person's reputation; similar to libel but in spoken form and often harder to prove	<i>Making false verbal statements that damage someone's reputation is a slandorous behaviour</i>
Tabloid (newspaper, for instance)	A small-format newspaper or magazine that typically focuses on sensational stories, celebrity gossip, and eye-catching headlines; can also refer to the sensational style itself	The tabloid ran a headline accusing a film star of an affair to boost sales.

unscrupulous	Acting without moral principles or ethical restraint; willing to deceive or exploit for personal gain.	a unscrupulous reporter might fabricate quotes or bribe officials to get a story.
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THEME 4 : SCIENCE / TECHNOLOGY AND ECOLOGY

LEXICAL ITEMS	EXPLANATION (S)	EXAMPLES
biodegradable packaging	Materials used to wrap or contain products that can be broken down naturally by microorganisms into water, carbon dioxide	<i>The use of biodegradable packaging has significantly reduced plastic waste in the supermarket.</i>
biodiversity	The variety and variability of life in a particular habitat, ecosystem, or on the entire Earth, including species diversity	A tropical rainforest with thousands of plant and animal species has high biodiversity .
Biofuels	Fuels produced from living matter , such as plant material or animal waste, used as an alternative to fossil fuels; examples include ethanol and biodiesel.	Ethanol made from corn is a common biofuel blended with gasoline.
erosion	The process by which soil, rock, or land surface is worn away and transported by natural forces such as water, wind, or ice.	Heavy rainfall on a hillside without vegetation can cause erosion that washes soil into nearby streams
extinct	The state of a species, family, or other group of organisms that no longer exists anywhere on Earth	The dodo is an extinct bird that lived on Mauritius.
breakthroughs	Significant advances or sudden important developments in science, technology, medicine, or other fields that solve a problem or open new possibilities.	A new cancer drug that dramatically improves survival rates can be described as a medical breakthrough .
poaching	The illegal hunting , capturing, or trade of wildlife, often targeting protected or endangered species .	Elephants are hunted for ivory; such illegal killing is poaching .
cryogenics	The science and technology concerned with producing and using very low temperatures and studying the behavior of materials at those temperatures.	Cryogenics is used to preserve biological samples by freezing them at very low temperatu
bioclimatology	The study of the interactions between the climate system and living organisms, including how climate affects the distribution and behavior of species and ecosystems.	Bioclimatology can help predict how plant ranges shift as temperature and rainfall patterns change

cybernetics	An interdisciplinary field studying systems, control, and communication in animals, machines, and organizations	Cybernetics principles are used to design a thermostat that maintains room temperature through feedback control.
microchip	an integrated circuit that contains many tiny electronic components (transistors, resistors) used to perform computing or control tasks.	The microchip inside a smartphone processes data and runs applications.
safeguard	An action, mechanism, or policy designed to protect people, systems, or environments from harm, loss, or undesirable outcomes.	Encryption is a safeguard that protects digital communications from unauthorized access
technophile	A person who loves, embraces, or enthusiastically adopts new technology	A technophile eagerly updates to the latest devices and explores new apps the day they're released.
technophobe	A person who fears, dislikes, or avoids new technology and may resist adopting technological changes.	A technophobe might prefer paper maps over GPS and avoid using social media
sustainable energy	Renewable energy with almost no harmful effects on the environment	Solar and wind power are forms of sustainable energy because they rely on renewable resources and produce little pollution.
genetic modification	The direct manipulation of an organism's genes using biotechnology to alter traits; also called genetic engineering.	Researchers are using genetic modification to create crops that can resist hard environmental conditions.
information superhighway	the global network of communication systems (especially the Internet) that enable rapid exchange and access to large amounts of information	The information superhighway allows people around the world to share research, news, and multimedia instantly.

PART 2 : POSITIVE OR NEGATIVE FRAMING (=TEXTUAL REPRESENTATION)

There are three types of framing :

- 1) Lexical framing using words (honest , liar , partner, enemy, angle, devil etc...) or proverbs

Examples of proverbs : *cut your coat according to your cloth* (= which means we cannot make judgements without proof)

all that glitters is not gold (=appearance can be deceptive and misleading)

2) Syntactic framing using grammatical structures

Examples : **WISH** + **SIMPLE PAST** = **REGRET IN THE PRESENT**

I WISH I COULD TRAVEL TO JAPAN

WISH + **PAST PERFECT** = **REGRET ABOUT A PAST ACTION**

I WISH I HAD KNOWN THE RESULTS OF THE INVESTIGATION A MONTH AGO .

***Sometimes we may replace the **past perfect** (*had known*) by **WOULD HAVE + PAST PARTICIPLE**

I WISH I WOULD HAVE KNOWN THE RESULTS OF THE INVESTIGATION A MONTH AGO .

3) Prosodic framing (rising intonation , falling intonation , question tags)

PART THREE : SYNTAX

1) Question tags are used for confirmation or clarification or sarcasm

They are composed of **statements and tags** ; they can be **negative** and **positive** or vice versa

MORE EXAMPLES from Modern Family TV SHOW

- We **should** (**positive statment**) probably go now, **shouldn't we** (**negative tag + inversion**)?" - Mitchell to Cameron
- "You **could** (**positive statement**) have called first, **couldn't you** (**negative tag**)?" - Claire to Phil
- "That **would** be amazing, **wouldn't it**?" - Phil to family
- "I **might not** be overreacting, **might I**?" - Cameron to Mitchell
- "You **must not** (**negative statement**) be joking, **must you** (**positive tag + inversion**)?" - Jay to Gloria
- "You **are not** serious, **are you**?" - Claire to Phil
- "He **is** always like this, **isn't he**?" - Mitchell about Cameron
- "They **have** already left, **haven't they**?" - Gloria to Jay
- "You **haven not** told her yet, **have you**?" - Phil to Luke
- "We **do** need to talk about this, **don't we**?" - Cameron to Mitchell
- "She **did not** mean it that way, **did she**?" - Phil about Claire
- "You **like** my new haircut, **don't you**?" - Gloria to Jay
- "Phil **knows** about the surprise party, **doesn't he**?" - Claire to Haley
- "Luke **forgot** his homework again, **didn't he**?" - Claire to Phil
- "Manny **tries** too hard sometimes, **doesn't he**?" - Jay to Gloria
- "You **want** to leave now, **don't you**?" - Cameron to Mitchell
- **Imperative (an order reflecting an authority)**: "**Give** me a minute, **will you**?" - Jay to family member.
- **Suggestion** : "**Let us** try something different, **shall we**?" - Phil suggesting family activities
- **Negative adverbs**: "they **never** told me about that, **did they**?" - Mitchell at a surprise

2) PERFECT MODALS :

Perfect Modals	Functions	Examples
Should + have + past participle	Used for blame , criticism or reproach	<i>Doctors were criticised for not doing their job well ; they should have received proper training before using AI diagnostic tools</i>
Must + have + past participle	used for past deduction . This deduction is based on clear evidence	<i>There is evidence that medical professionals must have considered ethical implications before adopting AI technologies.</i>
Would + have + past participle	Used for hypothetical situations ; it is always associated with the third conditional + the past perfect	<i>If the flight <u>had not been</u> delayed, we would have arrived in time for the international conference</i>